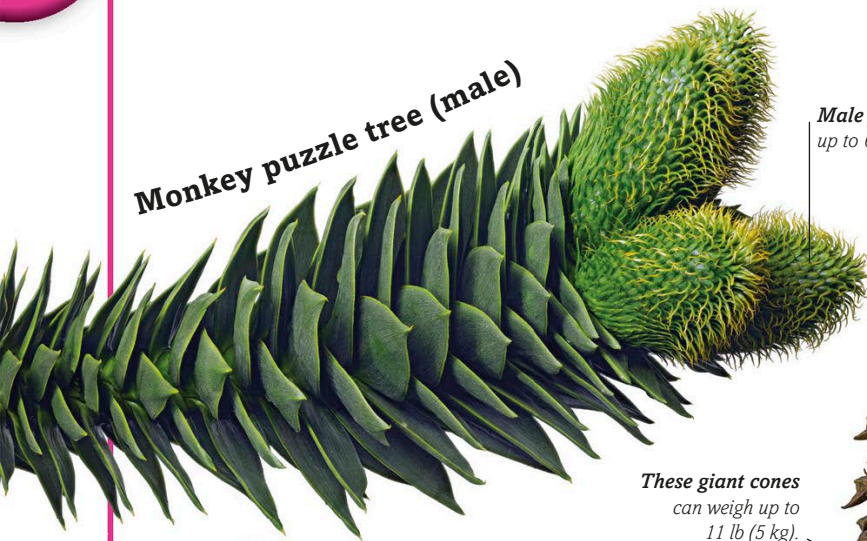


Conifer cones

Monkey puzzle tree (male)



Male pollen cones grow up to 6 in (15 cm) in length.

Tightly closed woody cones face down on branches.



Lodgepole pine

These giant cones can weigh up to 11 lb (5 kg).



Coulter pine

Red female cones sometimes grow 20 in (50 cm) long.



Zululand cycad

Female cones produce seeds about 18 months after pollination.



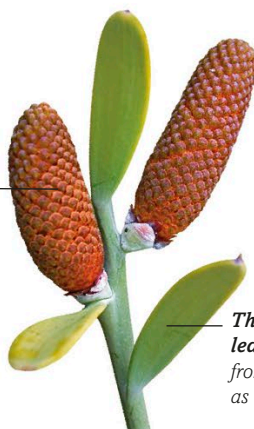
Wollemi pine (female)

Young red cones turn brown before releasing seeds.



European larch

Male cones can take up to a year to ripen, turn brown, and release pollen.



Kauri (male)

Each of these small yellow cones produces a single seed.



Outeniqua yellowwood

Thick, leathery leaves change color from bronze to green as they mature.



Common juniper

Round, green cones turn purple when ripe.



Conifer trees bear cones instead of flowers. All conifers have separate male and female cones, which sometimes grow on different trees. Male cones make pollen, while female cones, when pollinated, produce seeds. Cones come in many shapes, sizes, and colors, but all are pollinated by wind.

Conifers have a few tricks for dispersing their seeds. Some, such as the **Outeniqua yellowwood** and **common juniper**, make fleshy, berrylike cones. Birds eat the cones and spread the seeds in their droppings. Other conifers need specific conditions for seed dispersal.